



A SPELMAN CHRISTMAS

Genre: Holiday Family Drama / Comedy

Format: 90-Minute TV Movie

Tone: Heartfelt, funny, warm, and emotionally rich, like *This Is Us* meets *The Family Stone* with Black Southern elegance.

Tagline:

Because sometimes the only thing more complicated than family... is coming home to them.

LOGLINE

When a grieving Spelman professor tries to cancel Christmas after the loss of her husband, her three grown daughters return home uninvited, each carrying secrets, surprises, and sibling tension that threaten to turn the holidays into a disaster... until love, laughter, and a little bit of gumbo help them find their way back to each other.

THE STORY

Dr. Geneva Ellis is polished, poised, and profoundly tired. After losing her husband, she wants nothing more than to skip Christmas entirely. But when her three daughters, Zora, Simone, and Imani, show up at her West End Atlanta home with no warning and plenty of baggage, Geneva finds herself hosting a holiday she never wanted.

Zora's burned out from her D.C. power job. Simone's bringing a surprise white fiancé. And Imani's hiding a pregnancy. The Ellis women fall into old roles, old wounds resurface, and the house becomes a pressure cooker of grief, love, and long-simmering resentment. But as they reconnect through tradition, food, and an emotional candlelight service on Spelman's campus, something begins to shift.

Christmas morning dawns not perfect but real, honest, and full of healing.

WHY IT SELLS

- **Culturally rich & specific:** A Black Southern family anchored in Spelman pride and Atlanta's West End.
 - **Universal themes:** Grief, family reconnection, sisterhood, and second chances wrapped in a holiday bow.
 - **Holiday appeal:** A warm, cozy story set against Black holiday traditions, Southern food, and nostalgic music.
 - **Built for Mahogany / BET+ / OWN:** Perfectly aligned with audiences craving emotionally resonant, culturally specific, feel-good holiday content.
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CORE AUDIENCE

Women 25–54, especially Black women and families seeking authentic, relatable stories about grief, joy, family, and love during the holidays.

COMPS

The Best Man Holiday × This Is Us × A Nashville Country Christmas × The Family Stone